How to Make a Presentation

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My goal

For me to not be like this guy

Motivation

- In the past, “knowing information” was one of the most important aspect to achieve success in business.
- Google changed everything.
  - That is why the course is open book.
- Nowadays, there are only two important aspects that can make the difference out there:
  - Problem solving
  - Communication
    - That is why we are having this presentation!

Exercise

- Count the mistakes in here.

Things you must do
(and you usually forget)!

Have an outline

- The audience should know the roadmap, what will be presented and in which order.

Insert page number

- The audience needs to be able too ask question to a specific slide.

Insert progress

- In case of long presentation (e.g., more than 20 or 30 slides), it is useful to report the progress
  - e.g., page 20/500.

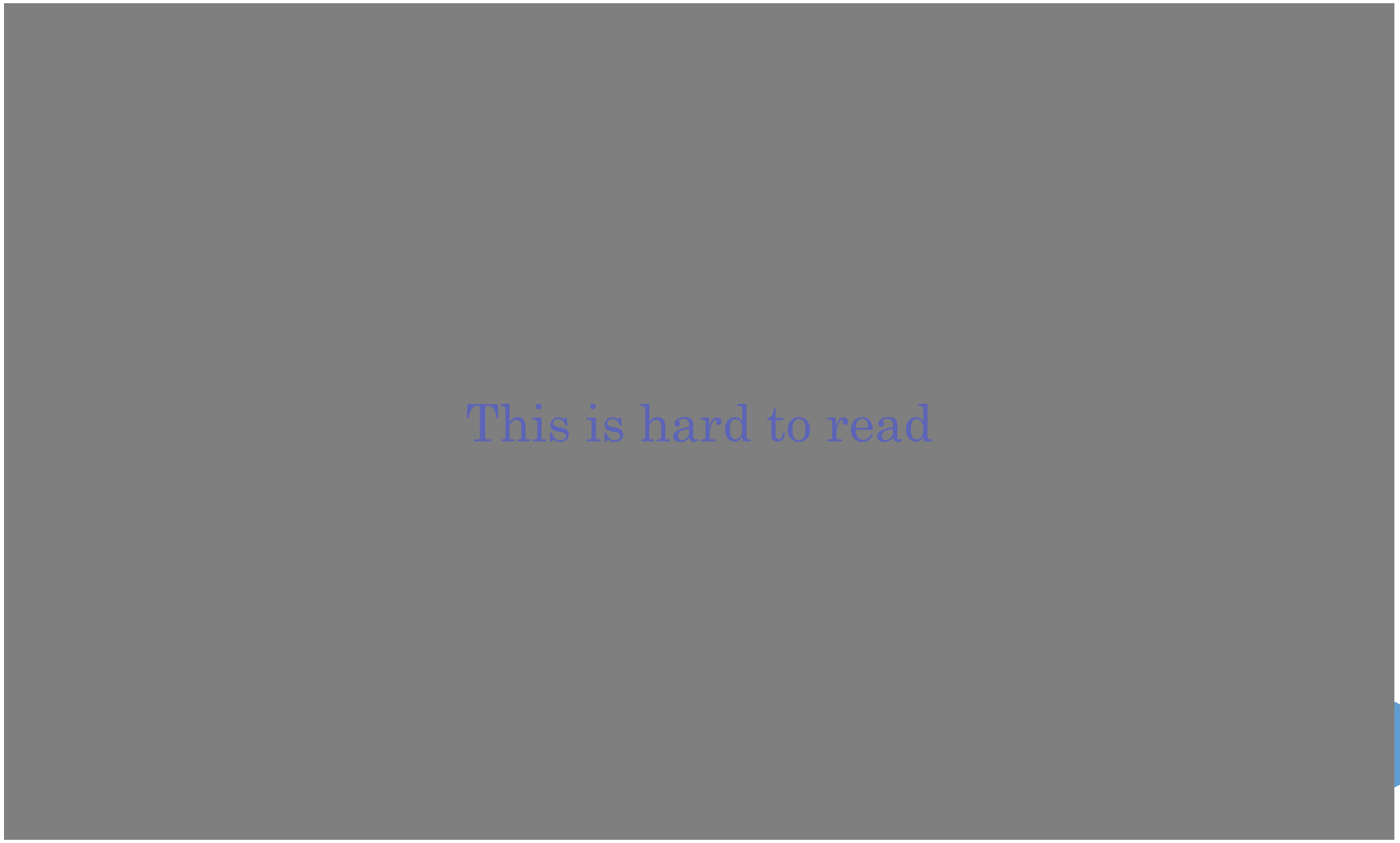
Refine a stable structure

- Here is an example of outline for a thesis or scientific presentation
  - Outline (1 slide)
  - Introduction (~ 3 to 5 slides)
    - Context (and terminology)
    - Problem
    - Aim/goal
  - Methodology (~ 60 % of "results and discussion")
  - Results and discussion (This is playoff time! The other sections just pave the way to this point.)
  - Conclusion and future work (~ 2 or 3 sides)
- There is no silver bullet, you need to refine the structure above to your specific circumstances.
- Introduce yourself, the title, etc.

Style and design matter

- Use black over white
- Use a **consistent** way to highlight *concepts* (bold, colors, etc.)
- Do not overestimate the performances (contrast and brightness) of a projector:
  - Screens are always good, projectors may be bad (light from windows, etc.).

Weak contrast



Avoid light text on a dark background

It is more difficult to read.

Some people can’t read it at all.

Using color is very risky.

Text versus picture

- Text: boring, distracting, but very precise.
- Picture: attractive, stimulating, very imprecise.

Explain pictures and tables

- Before jumping to the result (as we can see …) take your time explaining the characteristics of the table or figure.
  - Figure
    - Figure x shows…
    - The X axis reports… and it ranges from …
    - The Y axis reports… and it ranges from …
    - The different colors…
    - As we can see… (general trend)
    - For instance… (specific example)
  - Table
    - Column 1 reports …
    - Coulmn 2 reports …
    - Each row reports …
    - For instance, row 3 column 4 reports…
- Do not forget axes titles!

Be positive

- Be in the shoes of someone selling a car.
  - Will you buy a car if the seller is bored, unconfident, and nervous?
    - Indeed, you are selling something during a presentation: your work!

Practice, practice, practice

Confidence conveys **authority**

Nervousness undermines **confidence**

Practice alleviates **nervousness** by making **you** confident in what you will say

Engage audience

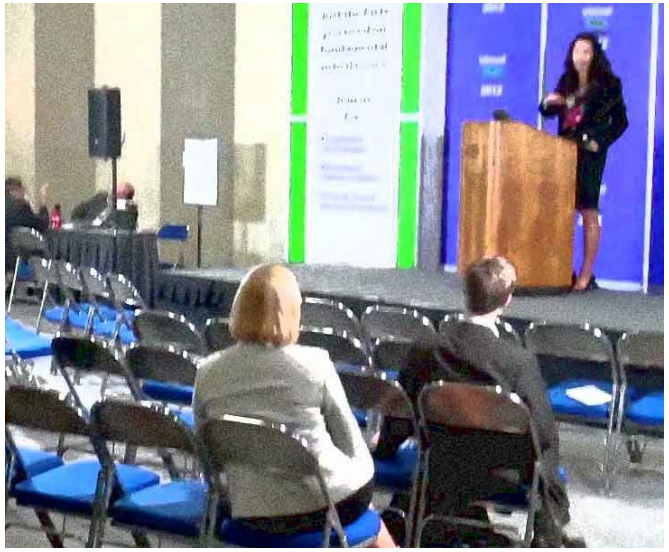
- Look into the eyes of the people
- Ask questions if you see strange faces
- Do not wake up people if they sleep
- Make jokes if you feel it is the time

Timing, timing, timing



Know the audience and the room







Things you will need







Things to get rid of









Answer to questions

- Be polite
- Do not feel threaten
- In most of the cases, you know more than the one asking question
  - Be confident
- You are not supposed to know all questions OR you are not supposed to have addressed all questions on all your work
  - "This is an excellent point. We defer to future studies …"

Exercise

- Count the mistakes.